scoring.dance

Judging Tablet Manual

Complete Guide for Dance Competition Judges

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Platform:	scoring.dance
WSDC Compliant:	Yes

■ **Video Tutorial Available**
For a visual walkthrough of the **scoring.dance** judging tablet system, watch our official tutorial video:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_3484YFtm7A

The video demonstrates the complete judging workflow from login to final submission, with helpful tips from experienced judges.

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of this Manual

This manual provides comprehensive guidance for judges using the **scoring.dance** tablet-based judging system at dance competitions. Whether you're a first-time judge or an experienced professional, this guide will help you understand all features and functions of the judging tablet system, ensuring accurate, fair, and efficient scoring.

The **scoring.dance** platform is designed to streamline the judging process while maintaining the integrity and standards required by the World Swing Dance Council (WSDC) and other governing bodies.

> ■ **Video Tutorial:** We recommend starting with our video tutorial at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_3484YFtm7A for a hands-on demonstration before reading this manual.

1.2 Overview of the scoring.dance Judging System

The **scoring.dance** judging tablet system represents a modern, digital approach to dance competition scoring with the following key features:

- **Real-time Scoring:** Scores continuously sync with the central scoring system
- **Multiple Judging Modes:** Choose between Scale, RAW, and TheOpen modes
- **Automatic Calculations:** System handles all mathematical computations
- **Visual Aids:** Color coding, markers, and notes help track competitors
- **WSDC Compliance:** Built-in adherence to WSDC registry event rules
- **Offline Capability:** Continue judging if connection is temporarily lost

The system supports both preliminary rounds (callback system) and finals (placement scoring), accommodating various formats including Jack & Jill, Strictly Swing, Classic, Showcase, and Rising Star divisions.

1.3 WSDC Compliance and Standards

For WSDC Registry Events, **scoring.dance** complies with all current WSDC rules:

- **Callback System:** Standardized point values (Yes = 10, Alt1 = 4.5, Alt2 = 4.3, Alt3 = 4.2, No = 0)
- **Relative Placement:** Standard placement scoring for finals
- **Raw Scoring:** Unique numerical scores assigned to all competitors
- **Minimum Requirements:** Supports required judge counts and finalist numbers
- **Integrity Standards:** Prevents tampering and unauthorized changes

The system maintains complete audit trails and provides WSDC-compliant reporting for points registry submissions.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Receiving Your Tablet

Before the Competition:

- Tablets are distributed at the **Judge Meeting Point** before each round
- If there is a Competition Coordinator, they will personally distribute and collect tablets
- Handle tablets with care - these are sensitive electronic devices
- **CRITICAL:** Keep all liquids and beverages away from tablets to prevent damage

Tablet Care Guidelines:

1. Hold the tablet securely with both hands when moving
2. Do not place tablets on surfaces where they could fall
3. **Never place drinks, water bottles, or any liquids near tablets**
4. Avoid placing heavy objects on top of tablets
5. Report any damage immediately to the Head Judge
6. Keep tablets in a safe location when not actively judging

> ■■ **Important:** Tablets are expensive equipment. Treat them as you would your own valuable electronics. After each round, return tablets immediately to the Judge Meeting Point or Competition Coordinator.

2.2 Initial Login

When you first receive your tablet and open the **scoring.dance** judging application, you'll see a list of available competitions.

Step-by-Step Login Process:

1. Select Your Competition
• You'll see a list of currently running competitions
• Tap the button for the competition you're assigned to judge
• Examples: 'Demo Jack&Jill; final', 'Demo Jack&Jill; prelim'

2. Select or Replace Your Judge Name
• A list of judges assigned to this competition appears
• Find and tap your name
• If replacing another judge: Tap the name of the judge you're replacing

3. Modify Name if Needed
• After selecting a name, you'll see a confirmation screen
• If there's a spelling error or if you're replacing someone, modify here

• Tap the name field to edit and enter the correct name

4. Start the Round

• After confirming your name is correct, tap the **START** button
• The system loads your judging interface
• You're now ready to begin scoring

> **Important Notes:**
> • If you select the wrong competition, navigate back and select the correct one
> • Name changes made during login are saved in the system
> • Your judge ID (e.g., 'L3054') is assigned by the system for tracking purposes

2.3 Understanding the Main Screen

Once you've started a round, you'll see the main judging interface. Understanding this screen is essential for efficient judging.

Header Section (Top of Screen):

- **Event Name:** The competition name (e.g., 'Demoevent')
- **Competition/Round:** Specific division (e.g., 'Demo Jack&Jill; prelim - Leader')
- **Judge Name:** Your name and Judge ID (e.g., 'Peter Parker (Judge L3054)')
- **Competition Stats:**

- 'Couples: 15' = Total number of couples in this round

- 'Yes: 5' = Number of couples to advance (the 'cut')

- 'Alt: 3' = Number of alternate positions available

- **Time:** Current time display (e.g., 'Sun 17:05')

Heat Tabs:

Competitions may be divided into multiple heats when there are many competitors:

- **heat 1:** First group of dancers
- **heat 2:** Second group of dancers (if applicable)
- **all:** View all dancers across all heats combined

You can tap these tabs to switch between views. However, you must judge ALL heats before completing the round.

Main Scoring Area:

This is where you'll see the list of competitors with:

- **BIB Number:** Large number on the left (e.g., '86', '124', '136')
- **Competitor Name:** Name of the dancer or couple
- **Role Indicator:** 'L' for Leader or 'F' for Follower (appears as a badge)
- **Score/Status Indicators:** Visual representation of your scores
- **Color Coding:**

- Green = Yes/High scores

- Yellow = Alternate/Medium scores

- Red/Pink = No/Low scores

Bottom Navigation Tabs:

- **ALL:** Shows all competitors in order

- **RANKED:** Shows competitors sorted by score (not recommended for judging)
- **TODO:** Shows only competitors you haven't scored yet
- **CONFLICTS:** Shows any scoring conflicts (in RAW and TheOpen modes)

Top Right Icons:

- **Eye Icon:** Screen blanking feature for privacy
- **Settings Icon (Gear):** Access judging mode and display options
- **Done Button:** Shows percentage complete and allows final submission

3. Judging Interface Overview

3.1 Competition Information Display

The header provides crucial information about what you're judging:

- **Competition Type:** Identifies the event (e.g., 'Demo Jack&Jill; prelim', 'Demo Jack&Jill; final')
- **Skill Level:** For Jack & Jill, shows Novice, Intermediate, Advanced, All Star, or Champions
- **Age Divisions:** Displays Juniors, Sophisticated, or Masters where applicable
- **Your Assigned Role:** Indicates if you're judging Leaders (L) or Followers (F)
- **Couples and Cuts:** Total competitors and advancement numbers

3.2 Icons and Controls

Eye Icon (Screen Blanking):

The eye icon provides privacy protection. Tap it to dim/gray out your screen completely, preventing others from seeing your scores. Tap anywhere on the screen to restore the view. Use this during finals or when you don't want competitors or spectators to see your scores.

Settings Icon (Gear):

Opens a menu with judging mode selection (Scale, RAW, TheOpen), display preferences (competitor names, marshalling status), and the Refresh/Reload function.

Done Button:

The Done button is your final submission control:

- Shows a percentage (e.g., '85%', '100%') of how many competitors you've scored
- Turns from gray to filled green when 100% complete
- Shows 'OFFLINE' in red if network connection is lost
- Becomes unclickable when offline or incomplete

4. Judging Modes Explained

The **scoring.dance** system offers multiple scoring modes to accommodate different judging preferences. All modes can be used in both preliminary rounds and finals.

4.1 Scale Mode (Default/Recommended)

Scale Mode is the most intuitive and widely used judging method. It uses a visual slider approach where you double-click on a horizontal scale to indicate your evaluation.

How It Works:

The scale is divided into five zones, each representing approximately 20% of the total range:

1. **Far Left (0-20%):** Absolutely No / Definite No
2. **Left-Center (20-40%):** No
3. **Center (40-60%):** Maybe / Neutral
4. **Right-Center (60-80%):** Yes
5. **Far Right (80-100%):** Absolutely Yes / Definite Yes

Scoring Process:

1. Watch a competitor dance
2. Double-click on the scale where your evaluation falls

• The further right you click, the better the score

• The further left you click, the lower the score

3. The system measures the exact position of your click
4. A raw score is calculated with precision to seven decimal places
5. Visual feedback appears immediately with color coding

■ **Advantages of Scale Mode:**
• Intuitive and fast
• Prevents exact duplicate scores (due to 7-decimal precision)
• Visual feedback helps you remember previous scores
• Easy to adjust scores by clicking in a different position
• **Recommended for most judges and competitions**

4.2 RAW Mode

RAW Mode allows you to manually enter specific numerical scores using a numeric keypad interface.

1. You see a numeric button interface (0-9)
2. You tap three digits to enter a score

3. The score is entered in format XX.X (e.g., tapping 7, 5, 3 = 75.3)
4. The numerical value is stored as your raw score

When to Use RAW Mode: When you prefer precise numerical control, have a specific scoring system in mind, or want to enter exact predetermined values.

> ■■ **Important:** RAW mode can result in score conflicts (two competitors with identical scores). The CONFLICTS tab will alert you if duplicate scores exist. You should resolve conflicts before submitting.

4.3 TheOpen Mode

TheOpen Mode combines elements of both Scale and RAW modes, offering a range-based scoring system with fine-tuning controls.

Method 1: Range Selection (70-100)
• Buttons display values from 70 to 98 (even numbers)
• A 'No' button for elimination
• Tap a button to assign that base score

Method 2: Numeric Keypad (0-9)
• Similar to RAW mode
• Tap three digits to enter a specific score
• Format: XX.X (e.g., 7, 5, 3 = 75.3)

Method 3: Plus/Minus Fine-Tuning
• After selecting a base score:
• Plus (+) button: Increase score by small increments
• Minus (-) button: Decrease score by small increments
• Allows precise adjustments without re-entering entire score

4.4 Scale (2 songs) Mode

This specialized mode is designed for spotlight finals where each couple dances to two separate songs. The system automatically calculates the average of both scores.

1. **During First Song:** Score each couple using your preferred method
2. **During Second Song:** Score each couple again for their second performance
3. **Calculation:** System automatically averages both scores

• Example: Song 1 = 80.0, Song 2 = 90.0, Final Score = 85.0

5. Preliminary Rounds (Callbacks)

5.1 Understanding Callback Scoring

Preliminary rounds use the WSDC Callback System to determine which competitors advance. The **scoring.dance** system implements this automatically.

Callback	Point Value	Meaning	Color Display
Yes	10	Definitely advance	Green
Alt 1	4.5	Strong alternate	Light Yellow
Alt 2	4.3	Medium alternate	Medium Yellow
Alt 3	4.2	Bubble alternate	Darker Yellow
No	0	Do not advance	Red/Pink

How Callbacks Work:

1. Each judge scores competitors as Yes, Alt (1-3), or No
2. The system sums all judges' point values for each competitor
3. Competitors are ranked by total points
4. The top scorers (based on the 'cut' number) advance to the next round

10. Troubleshooting and Best Practices

10.3 Best Practices

General Judging Practices:

1. Use ALL Tab for Primary Judging
Most stable view with predictable organization. Only switch to other tabs for specific purposes.

2. Use TODO Tab When Nearly Complete
At 80-90% completion, identify remaining work quickly and prevent missing dancers.

3. Avoid RANKED Tab for Active Judging
Constant re-sorting is confusing. Use only for post-scoring review.

4. Judge Independently
Don't look at other judges' tablets. Make your own evaluations. System integrity depends on it.

5. Double-Check Before DONE
Review TODO tab, scan scores in ALL tab, verify 100%, then submit with confidence.

Tablet Care Practices:

6. **Handle with Care** - Two hands when moving, don't set on edges
7. **Keep Liquids Away** - No drinks near tablets, prevent spills and damage
8. **Secure Placement** - Flat stable surface, away from dance floor edge
9. **Prompt Return** - Return immediately after completion to Judge Meeting Point

12. Appendices

12.1 Quick Reference Guide

Getting Started:
1. Receive tablet at Judge Meeting Point
2. Select competition → Select/replace judge name → START
3. Choose judging mode in Settings (Scale recommended)

Judging:
• **Scale Mode:** Double-click left (worse) to right (better)
• **ALL Tab:** Primary judging location
• **TODO Tab:** Find remaining dancers
• **DONE:** 100% complete + Green button → Click → Confirm → ✓

Important:
• Keep liquids away from tablets
• Return tablets immediately after green checkmark
• Don't judge in RANKED tab
• Ask Head Judge if uncertain

Troubleshooting:
• Re-score by clicking/tapping again
• Eye icon blanks screen (tap to restore)
• OFFLINE in red = no network (wait for reconnection)
• Missing dancers = check TODO tab

12.2 WSDC Callback System Reference

Tier	Competitors	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	Additional
1	5-10	3	2	1	0	0	0
2	11-19	6	4	3	2	1	0
3	20-39	10	8	6	4	2	1 (to 10th)
4	40-79	15	12	10	8	6	1 (to 12th)
5	80-129	20	16	14	12	10	2 (to 15th)
6	130+	25	22	18	15	12	2 (to 15th)

12.3 Glossary of Terms

ALL Tab: View showing all competitors in numerical/entry order

Alt / Alternate: Callback category between Yes and No; dancers who may advance if spots open

BIB Number: Large number identifying each competitor

Callback: Preliminary round scoring system indicating who advances

Chief Judge: Head official responsible for competition oversight and integrity

Conflicts: When two or more competitors have identical raw scores

DONE Button: Final submission control; becomes green at 100% completion

Heat: Subset of competitors when division is split into groups

Marshalling: Check-in process confirming competitor attendance

Placement: Final ranking (1st, 2nd, 3rd, etc.) in finals

RAW Mode: Judging mode using manual numeric entry

Raw Score: Underlying numerical value assigned to each competitor

RANKED Tab: View sorting competitors by current scores (not recommended for judging)

Scale Mode: Default judging mode using double-click on horizontal spectrum

Scratched: Competitor who withdrew or didn't appear; indicated by strikethrough

Spotlight: Finals format where couples dance individually

TheOpen Mode: Judging mode using 70-100 range with fine-tuning controls

TODO Tab: View showing only competitors not yet scored

WSDC: World Swing Dance Council - governing body for West Coast Swing competitions

12.4 Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What if I don't know the competitors - should I turn on 'Show Competitor Names'?

A: Personal preference. Many judges keep names off to reduce bias. Enable for spotlight finals if helpful.

Q: Can I switch judging modes in the middle of a round?

A: Yes. Previous scores remain; you just change how you score going forward. Best to stick with one mode though.

Q: What happens if I score someone twice by accident?

A: The latest score overwrites the previous score. No harm done - just ensure final score is correct.

Q: Can other judges see my scores?

A: No. Each tablet is private. Other judges cannot see your scores, markers, or notes.

Q: What if I disagree with another judge's scores?

A: That's normal and expected. Each judge evaluates independently. The system combines using Relative Placement.

Q: Can I change my scores after clicking DONE?

A: Only in exceptional circumstances with Head Judge approval. DONE is final - review carefully first.

Q: Do I need to score scratched dancers?

A: No. Scratched dancers (strikethrough names) are automatically excluded from completion percentage.

Q: What's the most important thing to remember?

A: Judge fairly, independently, and to the best of your ability. The system is a tool - your expertise matters most.

Conclusion

Thank you for serving as a judge and contributing to the dance competition community. The **scoring.dance** tablet system is designed to support your expert judgment, not replace it. Your dancing knowledge, experience, and fair evaluation are what make competitions meaningful for competitors.

Key Takeaways:

- **Handle tablets with care** - Protect these valuable tools
- **Judge independently and fairly** - Maintain integrity
- **Use ALL tab primarily** - Most efficient workflow
- **Review before submitting** - The DONE button is final
- **Ask questions when unsure** - Head Judge is there to help

■ **Remember:** Watch the tutorial video at https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_3484YFtm7A for a visual demonstration of these concepts.

Questions or Feedback?

Contact the event organizers or **scoring.dance** technical support team for:
- Additional training
- Technical assistance
- System suggestions
- Rule clarifications

Good luck and happy judging!

This manual is a living document and may be updated as the system evolves and new features are added.

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